

Pavan Kumar Nayakanti

Head of IT Infrastructure & Operations | 20+ Years | Banking & Financial Services | Data Centre | DR Planning | Multi-Cloud | ITIL

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Pune, India

EXPERIENCE

Sr. Specialist - Cloud Practice & SRE Lead

IRIS Software - India (Clients: ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO)

Sep 2020 - Present Hyderabad, India

- **Led IT operations and service delivery** for ADP's enterprise platforms - enforcing ITIL-aligned incident, problem, and change management across mission-critical HCM systems; reported KPIs and incident trends directly to C-suite and VP stakeholders.
- Designed and deployed full-stack **observability and monitoring stack (Prometheus, Grafana, Dynatrace, AppDynamics)** enabling real-time SLA tracking, root cause analysis, and proactive capacity management.
- **Built and scaled multi-location IT teams** from 4 to 40 engineers across India, Canada, and the US; stood up Charles Schwab's 18-member Platform Engineering team from zero - with incident governance, on-call frameworks, and structured change management.
- Led end-to-end **on-premise to AWS cloud migration for BMO CCB** - designed HA/DR architecture from day one with automated failover and disaster recovery; drove FinOps optimisation and proactive capacity planning across the AWS estate.
- **Governed vendor and MSP delivery** through operational scorecards, SLA tracking, and structured escalation frameworks; managed vendor contracts and third-party supplier performance across banking clients.
- Managed financial oversight of engineering delivery - contributed to **\$478K+ SOW closures**; controlled project budgets, resource allocation, and cost governance across multi-client engagements.
- Deployed **modeas high-throughput deployment platform** handling 200+ builds/hour - eliminating 10,000+ manual operational hours annually; drove process standardisation and automation of repetitive IT operations tasks.
- Established **chaos engineering practices (Keptn)** for proactive fault identification; hardened platform availability and continuity under real-world failure conditions.

Automation Technology Specialist

IRIS Software - Toronto, Canada (Client: Royal Bank of Canada Insurance)

Jun 2018 - Sep 2020 Toronto, Canada

- **Governed IT operations and compliance** across 250+ applications in RBC's regulated banking environment - enforced SOX/GDPR compliance, maintained audit-ready change transparency, and delivered structured regulatory reporting to senior management.
- Served as **single point of contact for IT operations governance** across RBC Insurance and Wealth Management - stakeholder management, vendor oversight, and cross-team coordination across 60+ delivery teams.
- Operationalised the **DORA framework** - tracking Deployment Frequency, Lead Time, Change Failure Rate, and MTTR as primary IT health metrics; reported regularly to Head of IT and LOB stakeholders.
- Implemented **Splunk-based log aggregation and alerting** integrated with delivery workflows - enabling proactive incident detection and rapid response for production environments.
- Designed the **Robo Deployment Framework** - self-service IT delivery pipeline for Windows services, database deployments, and enterprise app workloads; reduced application onboarding from **5 weeks to 5 hours** (98% reduction).
- Led enterprise migration of **250+ applications across 60+ teams** - full project lifecycle from scope definition through cutover, with milestones tracked and reported to senior management throughout.

SUMMARY

20+ year IT Operations and infrastructure leader with deep expertise in service delivery management, data centre continuity, DR planning, and regulatory compliance for global banking and financial institutions. Built and scaled multi-location IT teams from ground up (4 to 40 engineers) across ADP, RBC, BMO, and Charles Schwab. Expert in ITIL-aligned incident and change management, vendor governance, IT budget oversight, SOX/GDPR compliance, and executive-level reporting. Brings cloud delivery capability (AWS, Azure, GCP) alongside traditional IT operations leadership.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

MTTR -40% - ADP IT Operations
Cut incident resolution time by 40%+ via automated remediation, Dynatrace + AppDynamics monitoring, and ITIL-driven postmortem governance across mission-critical banking platforms.

4 → 40 Multi-Location IT Team
Scaled ADP's IT operations team from 4 to 40 engineers across India, Canada, and the US; built Charles Schwab's 18-member Platform Engineering function from zero with full operational governance.

Zero-Downtime DC Migration - Adobe
Owned complete data centre relocation for Adobe -- full migration plan, execution, and cutover -- with zero production impact and no business disruption across all critical workloads.

250+ App Compliance Governance
Governed IT operations and SOX/GDPR compliance across 250+ applications at RBC -- enforcing audit-ready change transparency, regulatory reporting, and vendor oversight for 60+ delivery teams.

Automation Architect

IRIS Software - Toronto, Canada (Insurance & Capital Markets)

Feb 2017 - Jun 2018 Toronto, Canada

- Designed **fault-tolerant Kubernetes and Helm-orchestrated deployment pipelines** enabling zero-downtime rollouts across capital markets platforms; established container orchestration standards.
- Led enterprise automation delivery - **80+ applications and 250+ components** automated across Java, NodeJS, Kafka, Salesforce, and Mainframe stacks; standardised Python automation frameworks at scale.

Technology Manager

TechMahindra Pvt. Ltd. - Noida, India (Client: Adobe)

Jul 2015 - Feb 2017 Noida, India

- Architected and delivered **zero-downtime business application migration** during Adobe's data centre relocation - owned the full migration plan, execution, and production cutover across all workloads with zero business disruption.
- Led SAP HANA upgrades and schema redesign; executed ETL re-engineering and data migration at enterprise scale with minimal service disruption to core business applications.

Sr. SDET - QA, Automation & Production Engineering

Microsoft Corporation - India

Jul 2007 - Dec 2014 Hyderabad, India

- Held dual mandate as Production Engineering owner - **full IT operations lifecycle** for Sales & Marketing platforms serving US, EMEA, and APAC subsidiaries; owned Windows and Linux infrastructure administration and sustained **99.99% uptime over 7 years**.
- Managed end-to-end production operations: **incident response, RCA, infrastructure administration, capacity planning**, and cross-team coordination - zero customer-impacting incidents sustained over the tenure.
- Defined and enforced all non-functional objectives (performance, availability, scalability, security) across network, infrastructure, and application tiers for global operations.

CERTIFICATIONS

ITIL Certificate in IT Service Operations

Axelos

Certified SRE (iSRE)

iSRE Institute

PMI Agile Certified Professional (PMI-ACP)

Project Management Institute

AWS Solutions Architect - Associate

Amazon Web Services - 2026

Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305)

Microsoft

Certified Kubernetes Application Developer

CNCF - 2025

EDUCATION

Masters in Artificial Intelligence 2024

Woolf University

General Management Program (GMP)

2022

ISB Hyderabad

M.Sc in Computer Science 2002

Osmania University